LITTLE WONDERS ESL

Chemistry Word Lab: Why iron rusts

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · oxygen, water and metal



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am a red-brown layer on old iron. I need oxygen and water to grow.
2. A coat of me protects iron from air and water. Walls and cars have me.
3. I am a strong metal made mostly of iron. Bridges and cars are often made of me.

2 COOL FACT: A SLOW REACTION

Rust is a red-brown layer that forms on **iron** and **steel**. Iron rusts when it touches both **oxygen** and water. This is a slow chemical reaction. Rust is weak, so it flakes off and the metal becomes thin. Salt water makes iron rust faster, so ships and cars near the sea rust quickly. We can stop rust with **paint**, with oil or with a layer of **zinc**. Stainless steel does not rust easily because it contains chromium.

flakes off = comes off in small thin pieces

layer = a thin covering

contains = has inside it

stainless steel = a kind of steel that does not rust easily

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

G	S	T	E	E	L	I	I	O	T	T	S
E	P	E	A	O	F	R	A	T	R	M	J
N	I	C	U	X	Z	O	N	I	E	A	U
P	A	M	T	Y	C	N	N	B	P	Z	T
Z	A	O	E	G	O	I	L	E	A	I	R
T	S	Y	G	E	G	A	O	F	I	N	N
Y	M	B	U	N	S	J	R	P	N	C	A
W	A	T	E	R	U	S	T	T	T	T	K

WORD BANK

- ☐ **rust**
- ☐ **paint**
- ☐ **steel**
- ☐ **iron**
- ☐ **oxygen**
- ☐ **water**
- ☐ **zinc**
- ☐ **oil**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. What two things does iron need to rust?
2. Why do cars near the sea rust quickly?
3. How can we stop rust?